



Now is the time to indulge yourself in a little pampering. When booking beauty treatments, always make it known that you're pregnant.

ASK A DOCTOR

I haven't felt my baby move for four hours. Should I be worried? Contact your doctor and explain your baby's usual pattern of movements. They can examine you and provide reassurance. Try lying down—your baby is more likely to sleep when you're active—and have something sweet to eat. Try encouraging your baby to move around (see [You are 18 weeks and 4 days](#)).

ON YOUR FEET

You may find it harder to be on your feet, especially for long periods of time. Weight gain, changes in your center of gravity (particularly during the second and third trimesters), and hormones can cause foot pain and swelling (see [Wearing maternity support stockings](#) and [Swollen feet, ankles, hands, and wrists](#)). The hormones that relax your joints ready for childbirth can also work to loosen the ligaments in your feet and hips, which can cause some discomfort. To minimize foot discomfort:

- **Wear athletic shoes** that have a good arch support to help reduce strain on your spine. They may also prevent a condition called plantar fasciitis—this is where the large ligament that